

João Roberto Lawall Soares

Systems Engineer | Rust & Go | Distributed Systems & Infrastructure

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Summary

Systems engineer who writes idiomatic Rust and ships fault-tolerant distributed systems. 29 merged PRs to Zed Editor (70k+ stars) — 5,800+ lines of Rust across 15+ subsystems, from rendering framework deadlocks to event-driven state machines. Day job: own Go microservices processing 140M+ monthly transactions with on-call responsibility, debugging production concurrency issues, and running containerized deployments on Kubernetes. Built high-performance Rust backends for cryptographic proof verification, API gateways (axum), and WASM-compiled client libraries. 6+ years of hands-on operational work, from incident triage to performance profiling. Mentor engineers on systems design and code review.

Open Source — Rust

Zed Editor • [GitHub \(70k+ Stars\)](#) — Idiomatic Rust

54 PRs submitted (29 merged) across 15+ subsystems, 5,800+ lines. Triage bugs, debug complex state, participate in design discussions, write constructive code reviews:

- Found and fixed a macOS deadlock in the GPUI rendering framework where re-entrant key status changes froze the UI. Diagnosed via event-driven state analysis. ([#51035](#) – Merged)
- Reworked picker selection logic across 11 files — stateless fault-tolerant pattern so non-selectable entries can't confirm unintended actions. ([#50705](#) – Merged, +185/-51)
- Fixed **formatter**: "auto" silently failing when language servers couldn't format. Required tracing through async service resolution. ([#50661](#) – Merged)
- Stopped agent panel from stealing focus on workspace restore — broke keyboard shortcuts across modals. ([#50511](#) – Merged, +116/-62)
- Fixed SVG renderer not rendering text when system fonts unavailable. ([#51623](#) – Merged, +120/-7)
- Fixed escape characters leaking into LSP diagnostic messages rendered via markdown. ([#51766](#) – Merged, +195/-27)
- Fixed deleted files persisting in project search results — stale state in distributed file watcher. ([#50551](#) – Merged, +175/-18)
- Debugged terminal rendering missing first line due to floating-point tolerance in layout calculation. ([#52111](#) – Merged)
- Fixed semantic tokens not appearing when opening buffer from multibuffer. ([#53712](#) – Merged, +290/-24)
- Fixed edit predictions polluting completions menu. ([#50403](#) – Merged, +148/-10)
- Ensured language servers from extensions properly start on workspace restoration. ([#51308](#) – Merged, +106/-2)
- Also: vim clipboard fix, terminal SIGTERM handling, theme selector improvements, code action clearing, git panel jitter fix, and more. ([View all PRs](#))
- 5 PRs (all merged) to OCaml extension: Dune package management, MLX file support, LSP argument forwarding. ([View all PRs](#))

Professional Experience

Platform Builders

Senior Backend Engineer

Brazil (Remote)

Aug 2025 – Present

Full-time | RD Saúde – Brazil's largest pharmaceutical retailer

- Own fault-tolerant Go microservices in a distributed system processing 140M+ monthly transactions. On-call for production incidents. Debug and resolve escalations under time pressure.
- Diagnosed and fixed a critical concurrency bug in Apache Kafka consumers — race condition causing duplicate invoices. Used mutex-based synchronization to reach 99.99% idempotency.
- Troubleshoot and resolved production performance issues. Reworked goroutine management, dropping system latency 40%. Profile with pprof, debug with delve.
- Migrated database layer from Oracle to PostgreSQL with zero downtime. Rewrote execution plans and added indexes, cutting query times by over 1 minute.
- Own CI/CD pipelines and containerized deployments on Docker and Kubernetes. Observable systems with Grafana, Prometheus, and ELK Stack.
- Lead architecture discussions and cross-team design reviews. Mentor 5 engineers on concurrency patterns and distributed systems. Team velocity up 30%.
- Write technical documentation, runbooks, and post-mortems.
- Tech Stack: Go (Golang), Apache Kafka, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD, AWS, Linux, REST API, Microservices, Grafana, Prometheus.

Docile Alimentos LTDA

Backend Engineer

Lajeado, RS, Brazil (On-site)

Jan 2020 – Aug 2025

Full-time

- Built Go backend services with event-driven patterns. Implemented concurrency patterns that increased throughput 50%.
- Decomposed a Java/JSF monolith into stateless microservices with event-driven messaging via RabbitMQ. 40% performance gain.
- Containerized all services with Docker. Managed Kubernetes deployments across environments with CI/CD pipelines and monitoring.
- Optimized 20+ database queries across PostgreSQL, MongoDB, and SQL Server. Cut MongoDB query times by 85% (30s reduction).
- Shipped 50+ bug fixes and features with tests on every change. 98% on schedule. Participated in code reviews and on-call rotation.

- Tech Stack: Go, Java, Spring Boot, NestJS, Docker, Kubernetes, Linux, MongoDB, PostgreSQL, Redis, RabbitMQ, REST API, CI/CD, Grafana.

Borderless Coding
Technical Mentor

London Area, UK (Remote)
Sep 2025 – Present

Part-time

- Mentored 60+ engineers on systems architecture, API design, and debugging methodology. 95% satisfaction rate.
- Led 20+ workshops. Coach engineers to step into technical leadership roles.

Rust Projects

DarkPool-Exchange | High-Performance Settlement Engine • [GitHub](#)

Rust backend for a batch auction settlement system. Built halo2/arkworks cryptographic circuits, client-side proof generation compiled to WASM and native CLI, proof aggregator that batches individual proofs into one verification pass, and integration with on-chain verifier contracts. Order data stays encrypted until settlement.

zkSettle | Rust API Gateway & Compliance Backend • [GitHub](#)

Off-chain Rust workspace: axum API gateway, OFAC sanctions updater with Sparse Merkle Tree, Helius-webhook indexer, proof verification service. Anchor program verifying Groth16 proofs under 200K compute units. All compliance checks logged and auditable.

Auto-Issue | Go Backend with Concurrency Primitives • [GitHub](#)

Go backend: work queue with concurrency limiter, process orchestrator managing lifecycle state machines, git worktree isolation, SSE streaming, REST API with 15+ endpoints. GORM with PostgreSQL.

Technical Skills

Rust: Idiomatic Rust, async/await, WASM compilation, systems-level debugging, cryptographic libraries (halo2, arkworks), axum
Systems Engineering: Fault-Tolerant Systems, Stateless Services, Event-Driven Patterns, Distributed Systems, On-Call Operations
Go (Golang): Goroutines, channels, mutexes, pprof, delve, race detector, Go modules, code generation
APIs: REST APIs, GraphQL, gRPC, Event-Driven APIs, API design and evolution, Public API stability
Observability: Grafana, Prometheus, ELK Stack (logging, monitoring, tracing), Application Performance Monitoring
Infrastructure: Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD Pipelines (GitHub Actions, GitLab CI), AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda), Linux
Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch, MySQL, SQL Server, Query Optimization
Messaging: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, Amazon SQS, Event-Driven Architecture
Process: Code Reviews, Technical Documentation, Architecture Decisions, Cross-Team Collaboration, Mentoring

Education

Universidade do Vale do Taquari - Univates

2021 – 2025

Bachelor's Degree, Computer Science

Languages

English – Proficient (Professional Working Proficiency)

Portuguese – Native Speaker